

The Earth's cycles

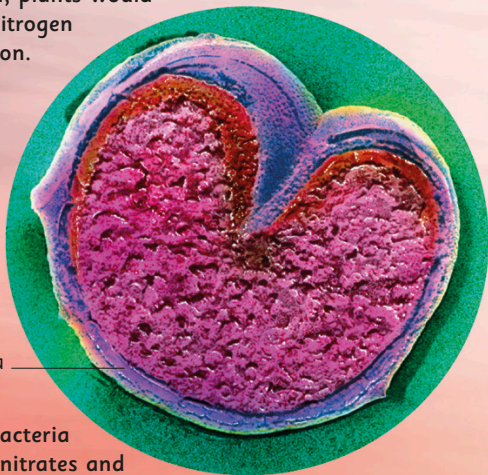
Everything in nature is recycled. Living things take in oxygen, nitrogen, carbon, and water and use them to live. When they die and decompose, the substances they are made of are used again.

Nitrogen cycle

All living things need nitrogen. Plants take in nitrogen from the soil. Animals get nitrogen from eating plants. When animals and plants die, they put nitrogen back into the soil.

Certain bacteria play an important role in the nitrogen cycle. They change nitrogen into the form plants can use. Without bacteria, plants would die of nitrogen starvation.

Bacteria



Other bacteria take in nitrates and release nitrogen back into the atmosphere.

Animals eat plants, which contain nitrates.



Nitrogen is abundant in our atmosphere.

Decaying animals and plants put nitrogen back into the soil.



At night, plants take in oxygen and give out carbon dioxide.

